

Newborough Warren

Weather & Water Watch

March 2026

Weather Summary

Metric	Newborough (ILLANF24)	RAF Valley	Typical March*
Total Rainfall	N/A†	51.4 mm	~57.0 mm
Average Highs		11.3°C	9.8°C
Average Lows		5.7°C	4.5°C
Sunshine		143.8 hrs	125.7 hrs
Air Frost		1 day	~3 days

**Based on 1991–2020 Met Office climate averages (RAF Valley). †ILLANF24 gauge unreliable this month (sensor spike); excluded.*

After the deluge of January and February, March came as something of a relief. The 51.4 mm recorded at RAF Valley is close to the long-term average of 57.0 mm — sitting right at the 50th percentile in the historical record. Nothing exceptional in either direction.

What was notable was the warmth and sunshine. Maximum temperatures of 11.3°C were well above the 9.8°C average, and with 143.8 hours of sunshine compared to the usual 125.7, it felt properly spring-like. Only one day of air frost was recorded — a far cry from the typical three. Temperatures were milder than usual with lows of 5.7°C against a 4.5°C average.

Rainfall dropped from 76.0 mm in February to 51.4 mm — a decrease of about a third. This is significant for what's happening underground, because as days lengthen and temperatures rise, evapotranspiration starts to ramp up. The vegetation is waking up, and the forest canopy is beginning to intercept more rainfall.

The hydrological year cumulative (October to March) stands at 617 mm, still 126% of the long-term average (491 mm). Despite a near-normal March, the reservoir of water banked underground during the exceptionally wet winter remains substantial.

Local Water Levels: The Turning Point

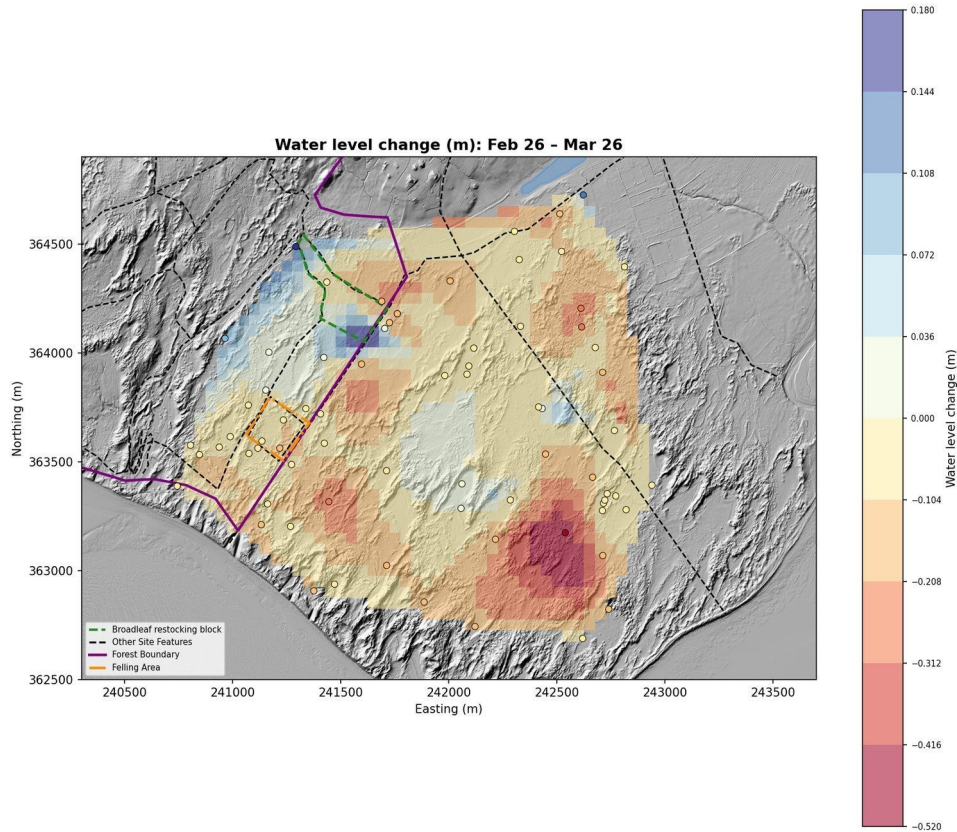
This month marks the seasonal turning point. The well round on 30th March covered 77 dipwells, and the picture has shifted dramatically from February's across-the-board rises.

Out of 77 wells, 61 are now falling, only 5 are still rising, and 11 are stable. The mean change is -0.075 m — a modest but unmistakable signal that the spring recession has begun.

Month-on-Month Change: February – March 2026

The month-on-month map reveals a striking east–west split. The western block near the forest and rock ridge (left side of the map) still shows pockets of blue where a few wells continue to rise. But the eastern block and central reserve are firmly in orange and red, with the largest declines in the fast-draining sand aquifer.

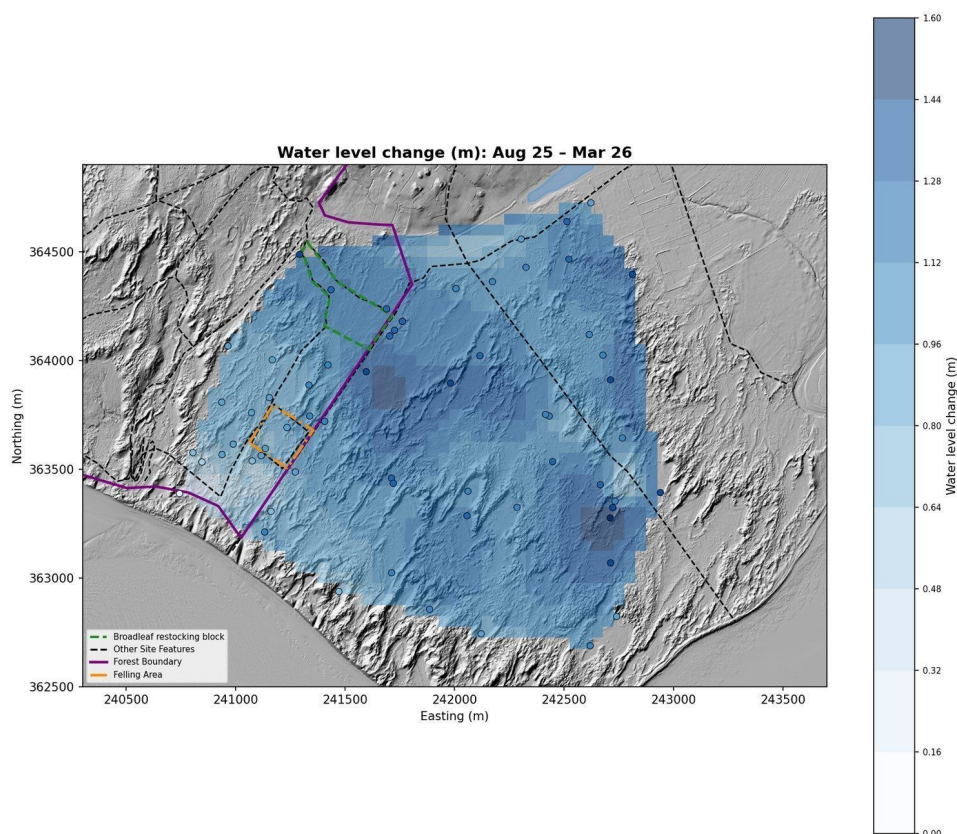
The largest drop was at ceh10, which fell 0.50 m in a single month — one of the more responsive wells in highly permeable sand. Other notable declines were at nw6 (−0.25 m), D7 (−0.23 m), and D10 (−0.21 m). The few wells still rising are in the western block: ceh14 (+0.16 m) sits close to the geological boundary where groundwater continues to feed the system, and ceh6 (+0.11 m) near Llyn Rhos Ddu likely reflects delayed through-flow from the winter recharge pulse.



Water level change (m) from 28 Feb 2026 to 30 Mar 2026. Blue = rising, red = falling.

Rebound from Summer Low: August 2025 – March 2026

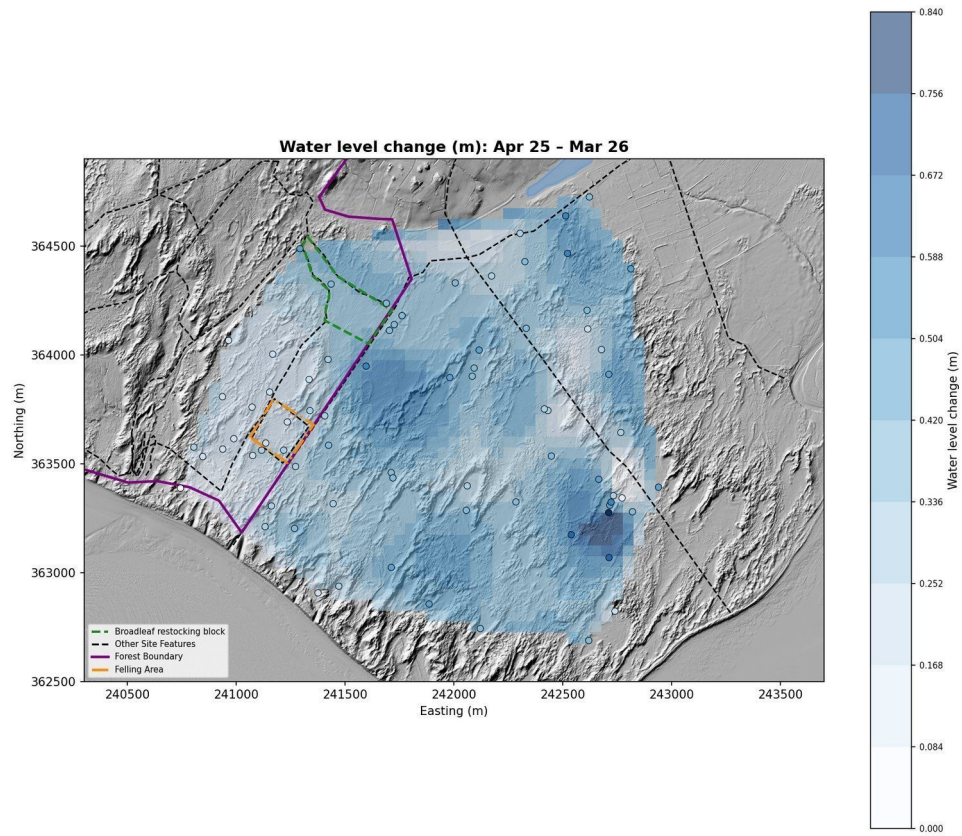
Since the summer low in August 2025, the net picture remains strongly positive. Across 63 wells with comparable data, the mean rise is +1.043 m (range +0.29 to +1.55 m). The water table is still well above its summer baseline despite a month of predominantly falling levels. The dune slacks, while starting to dry back from their winter maximum, remain considerably wetter than average heading into spring.



Cumulative water level change since 31 Aug 2025.

Year-on-Year: April 2025 vs March 2026

Despite the early onset of the spring decline, water levels remain substantially higher than at this point in 2025. Comparing the 30th March reading to the closest date last year (1st April 2025), every single one of the 76 comparable wells is higher, by an average of +0.349 m (range +0.06 to +0.79 m). The wet winter has given the aquifer a significant buffer heading into the drying season.



Year-on-year water level change from 01 Apr 2025 to 30 Mar 2026.

Well Measurement Summary

Largest Risers and Fallers (month-on-month)

Well	Change (m)		Well	Change (m)
ceh14	+0.160		D5	+0.000
ceh6	+0.110		ceh40	−0.010
ceh13	+0.090		ceh25	−0.200
ceh2	+0.030		D7	−0.230
nw2	+0.020		nw6	−0.250

Full data: 77 wells. Mean: −0.075 m. Range: −0.500 to +0.160 m.

Looking Ahead

The key question going into April and May is how quickly the recession progresses. If we get a normal spring with intermittent Atlantic fronts, the decline should be gradual and the dune slacks will hold water well into June — good news for natterjack toad breeding. If a dry spell sets in, the more responsive eastern wells could drop quickly.

The ILLANF24 gauge continues to be unreliable — the sensor recorded a spurious 756 mm spike on March 12th. Even excluding this, the remaining daily totals sum to over four times what Valley recorded. It may be worth considering a service visit or switching to an alternative station such as IBODOR6 for local rainfall cross-referencing.